

When India became independent, there were very few senior Indian naval officers. Therefore, the government ‘borrowed’ British officers to fill senior posts up to 1958, when Katari took over from SH Carlill as Chief of the Naval Staff.

RD Katari had a passion for crosswords, which included both solving and creating them. He was the anonymous creator of *The Hindu’s* first cryptic crossword in 1971 and continued to create crosswords for the paper throughout the 1970s.